

1                   **HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES - FLOOR VERSION**

2                               STATE OF OKLAHOMA

3                               2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

4   HOUSE BILL 2970

                              By: Rosecrants of the House

5                                               and

6                                               Bullard of the Senate

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9                               AS INTRODUCED

10           An Act relating to definitions and general  
11           provisions; amending 25 O.S. 2021, Section 98.6,  
12           which relates to the state fossil; modifying state  
                  fossil; modifying descriptive provisions; and  
                  providing an effective date.

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17   BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

18           SECTION 1.        AMENDATORY        25 O.S. 2021, Section 98.6, is  
19   amended to read as follows:

20           Section 98.6.   Because of the extraordinarily rich  
21   paleontological heritage of the State of Oklahoma, the Legislature  
22   hereby declares ~~Saurophaganax Maximus~~ Sauroposeidon proteles to be  
23   the State Fossil of Oklahoma. ~~This spectacular dinosaur, the~~  
24   ~~"greatest king of reptile eaters", once roamed this great land. It~~

1 ~~is only known from Oklahoma and has surpassed the Tyrannosaurus rex,~~  
2 ~~the "king of the dinosaurs", as the greatest predator of earth's~~  
3 ~~history~~ This Early Cretaceous sauropod dinosaur is among the tallest  
4 ever discovered. When found in Atoka County in Southeast Oklahoma  
5 in 1994, the fossils were so large they were initially mistaken for  
6 petrified tree trunks. These fossils have been essential to  
7 understanding the species and highlight Oklahoma's important role in  
8 the study of prehistoric life.

9 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

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11 COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON COMMERCE AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT  
12 OVERSIGHT, dated 03/03/2026 - DO PASS.  
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